

Digital Footprint Reflection

Updated June 2026 for mobile readability and standards-review clarity.

Digital Footprint Reflection

Cybersecurity & Digital Ethics Starter Kit | Student Activity

Security skills should help students protect people, systems, and information.

Digital Footprint Reflection

Student Activity

Audience: Students | Grades 8-12

Purpose

- Your digital footprint is the trail of information connected to you online. Some information is posted by you. Some may be collected by apps, devices, websites, or services. The goal of this activity is to think carefully about what you share, who can see it, and how it could affect your privacy, safety, reputation, and future opportunities.

Student-safe note

- Use fictional examples. Do not use real passwords, real accounts, live suspicious links, or private information.

Standards summary

- This resource may support CSF 13.1, CSF 14.1, CSF 14.3.
- Detailed alignment depends on local district pacing, approved course placement, and teacher directions.

Student Directions

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Part 1: Sort the Information

Information Type

Privacy Level

Reason

Full name

Think carefully

May be public in some settings, but still deserves care

Home address

Private

Can create safety risk

School project

Depends

May be appropriate if teacher-approved

Password or

verification code

Never share

Can allow account takeover

Photo with location

visible

Think carefully

May reveal where you are or where you

live

Part 2: Scenario Reflection

- A student posts a picture that shows a school ID badge. What information might be exposed?
- A student asks an AI tool to summarize a private group chat. What privacy issues might this create?
- A student uses the same username and password on many sites. What could happen if one site is breached?
- A student shares a location-tagged photo while away from home. What should they consider?

Part 3: My Digital Footprint Action Plan

One type of information I should protect:

One privacy setting I should check:

One thing I should avoid sharing with AI tools:

One future-ready digital habit I want to build:

Teacher Note

Keep the activity reflective and non-punitive. Do not ask students to expose personal accounts, search themselves publicly, or share private information in class.

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Detailed Tennessee Standards Connection

Tennessee Standards Connection

This reflection supports standards when students examine privacy, personal information, digital responsibility, and the long-term impact of online choices.

Standards source: Tennessee Department of Education, Computer Science Foundations (C10H11), May 2023. Confirm final alignment against local district pacing, approved course placement, and teacher directions.

This resource may support the following Tennessee standards when used as part of cybersecurity, digital ethics, computer science, AI literacy, or career-connected technology instruction:

- CSF 13.1 - Social, Legal, and Ethical Issues: Students research social, legal, and ethical issues encountered by IT professionals and identify responsibilities when addressing technology problems.
- CSF 14.1 - Data Security: Students explain why data security is a priority and demonstrate understanding of confidentiality, availability, and integrity.
- CSF 14.3 - Security Practices: Students identify security practices for computer and network systems, including access control, encryption techniques, BIOS features, and malware response strategies.

Item

Details

Estimated Time

30-45 minutes

Purpose

Help students reflect on how online choices, data sharing, privacy settings, and AI tools can shape digital identity and personal security.

Student Product

Personal reflection and action plan.

Use guidance

- Confirm final alignment against local district pacing, approved course placement, and teacher directions.
- Keep instruction defensive, ethical, age-appropriate, and classroom-safe.

Standards Review Standards review note (June 2026): Tennessee Computer Science Foundations course standards (C10H11) remain published by the Tennessee Department of Education as May 2023 standards. Standards references in this resource are intended as cautious instructional alignment notes; final alignment should be confirmed against local district pacing, course placement, and current district guidance.